

Why It's Worth Getting Aligned with One Another

When I got married, it would have been easy for me to take the lead in managing our money. After all, this is what I do for a living. And in relationships, usually one person takes a bigger role in important stuff like cooking or lawn work, right?

But money is different. I insisted that we manage our finances together—even when our conversations got really hard. (We had different views of money, different amounts of money coming into our marriage, and different views on what money could do for us.)

Here's why: One day, I might get hit by a bus. No matter if it's tomorrow or fifty years from now, I want my wife to be financially fluent enough to handle the finances of our family.

Another reason: To create a Rich Life, it's important that we both have skin in the game. Think of it like this: Have you ever planned a trip for people where you emailed them all and asked, "What's your travel style?" And everyone replied, "I'm easy. Whatever is fine!"

As the planner, did you then painstakingly construct a day-by-day itinerary, taking into account everyone's preferences, dietary restrictions, and budgets, only to finally arrive and suddenly hear complaining about every meal and destination and activity? No? Only me? I'm getting mad just thinking about it.

You and your partner will never be financially aligned unless you're both involved. Lawn work is one thing. But money cuts across everything in your Rich Life. Your involvement might mean creating a spending plan together, or deciding on what your dream house looks like, or opening up an IRA. You can decide on the division of labor together—but it's important that you're both involved.

Yes, it takes more work up front. But once you're both aligned, it's a lifetime of partnership. That's powerful.